International Labour Organization

Progress report on the technical cooperation programme between the Government of Qatar and the ILO

ILO Project Office for the State of Qatar

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Background

1. An annual progress report on the technical cooperation programme (TCP) between the ILO and the Government of Qatar has been published every year since 2018, and these reports are accessible on the ILO Qatar website.[1]

2. The objective of the annual progress report is to present key developments and priorities and keep interested parties informed about the broad scope of work undertaken by the ILO Project Office in Doha. This report covers the period from November 2023 to December 2024. In the past, the report was published around November each year to align with the sessions of the ILO's Governing Body. From now, it will be published in January to provide coverage for the full calendar year.

3. To further deepen the impact of the labour reforms adopted in recent years and to strengthen labour market institutions and policies, the TCP transitioned from Phase 2 (2021-2024) to Phase 3 (2024-2028). In March 2024, a Joint Work Programme (JWP) was signed by the ILO Director General and the Minister of Labour of Qatar. This four-year programme includes three strands: (i) Phase 3 of the TCP; (ii) a dedicated project to support the work of the international trade unions in Qatar; and (iii) a secondment programme for Ministry of Labour (MOL) officials to the ILO.[2]

4. Phase 3 of the TCP is in alignment with the recently launched National Development Strategy (2024–2030) and the Qatar National Vision (QNV) 2030, and also reflects the findings of an independent final evaluation of Phase 2 carried out in 2023. Phase 3 covers three pillars, which also form the structure of this report:

    - Pillar 1. Workforce policies
    - Pillar 2. Labour market governance
    - Pillar 3. International cooperation and exchange of experience

5. The administrative data presented in this report comes from Government of Qatar sources unless specified otherwise. Some elements of this report also reflect developments that are not strictly part of the TCP between the ILO and the Government of Qatar. However, they are included to provide further context on the progress of the labour reforms.

[1] The previous annual reports can be found here: 2023, 2022, 2021, 2020, 2019, and 2018.

[2] Phase 3 of the TCP is ongoing while the dedicated project with the international trade unions is still being finalized with an anticipated starting date in early 2025. More details on the JWP can be found here.

▶ The context in 2024

6. The work of the TCP in 2024 has been shaped by a number of factors. Most importantly, by the third National Development Strategy (NDS3) for 2024-2030, which was published in January 2024.

- In reflecting on the previous period and the goals outlined in the QNV 2030, the NDS3 refers to the labour reforms in the section on Human Development: "Notable progress has also been made towards a more fair and equitable labour market, with the introduction of reforms that set a minimum wage and improve worker mobility and protection."[3]
- The NDS3 includes a strategic national outcome on a "Future-Ready Workforce" and labour market goals are prominent throughout the entire strategy. The emphasis is on fostering a more skilled and productive workforce by attracting and retaining talent from abroad, upskilling Qatari nationals, and increasing the number of nationals in the private sector. In addition, the NDS3 highlights the importance of reforms to immigration policy, enabling new ways of working and further facilitating labour mobility.
- There are also relevant objectives in the outcome on "Sustainable Economic Growth," which identifies target sectors for diversification and focuses on creating an enabling environment including through creating a "level playing field," more "transparent and enforceable laws," and ensuring "quality and efficiency" in government services.[4] These points are mentioned in the context of creating a more business-friendly environment, but would also benefit workers and employers.

7. The National Planning Council (NPC) was established in May 2024 and will play a central role in overseeing and monitoring implementation of the ND3, including through endorsing and supporting national strategies and plans. This body replaces the Planning and Statistics Authority (PSA).

8. Moreover, a Workforce Planning Committee (WPC) was formed with the Minister of Labour as the Chair, and the President of the Civil Service and Government Development Bureau (CGB) and Secretary General of the NPC as the Vice Chair. The Committee includes representatives from the Ministries of Labour, Education and Higher Education, Commerce, Interior, Defense, Finance, the NPC, and the CGB. It also includes Qatar Central Bank and Qatar Energy. The Committee will support coordination for effective workforce planning in the public and private sector and identify challenges and set priorities to address them.

9. In November 2024, the Ministry of Labour launched the National Strategy for an Efficient and Highly Productive Workforce (2024-2030). The event was held under the patronage and presence of the Prime Minister and Minister of Foreign Affairs of the State of Qatar. The Strategy is in harmony with the NDS3 and focuses on (i) enhancing the efficiency and productivity of the workforce; (ii) empowering citizens and increasing their participation in the labour market; and (iii) improving the working environment and conditions in Qatar. The Strategy also prioritizes the enhancement of the Ministry's institutional performance and effectiveness, including by improving the use of technology and digital transformation.

10. The legislative framework is evolving. A law on job localization in private sector was adopted in October 2024, reflecting a top national priority. The NDS3 also sets a clear target for Qatari women and men to make up 20 per cent of the workforce in the private and semi-private sector. Another significant piece of legislation under consideration would make joint committees mandatory for companies. This would greatly enhance workers' voice, strengthen relations between workers and management at the enterprise level, and also establish a basis for social dialogue at the sectoral and national level.

[3] Third Qatar National Development Strategy 2024–2030 (NDS3). Pp. 10.

[4] NDS3. Pp. 15-20; 32.

11. Reflecting on the suite of legislation that was adopted between 2018 and 2021, there is broad acceptance of the legislation on the minimum wage, on occupational heat stress, and on the removal of exit permits. While there is increased recognition of the value of labour mobility, including in the NDS3, it is far from universal, and there is still resistance to it from many employers. Continued practices that contribute to restricting mobility risk undermining its positive impact for workers, employers and the economy overall. In particular, concerns have been raised on the extent to which domestic workers can change jobs or leave the country without their employers' permission; and, relatedly, the high costs that employers incur when recruiting domestic workers.

12. In line with the NDS3, a number of structural reviews are underway to identify gaps in the labour law related to implementation and the quality of services. Assessments are underway or planned in the areas of labour mobility, the labour inspection and occupational safety and health systems, dispute resolution systems, employment contracts, and social protection. The recommendations that emerge could inform labour laws and policies, and also the adoption of operating systems and procedures across MOL departments and units to ensure the consistency and quality of services.

13. These reviews also seek to further digitalize the work of the MOL and enhance online services, an area that has seen a major step forward in the past year. The digital transformation is an explicit policy of the MOL and the Government more broadly, as set out in the NDS3. This is evident in the ongoing development of the Labour Market Information System (LMIS), the launch of several online job-matching platforms, and revamping of the various e-services on the MOL website.

14. An encouraging feature of 2024 has been the significant increase in engagement with migrant community leaders by the MOL and the Workers' Support and Insurance Fund (WSIF). The community leaders are associated with embassies, the National Human Rights Committee (NHRC), international trade unions, and NGOs, among other institutions. This heightened community outreach has increased awareness among migrant workers of their rights and obligations, as well as the range of services available to them. It has also enabled greater cooperation with the various government and non-government entities by creating opportunities for feedback from the community leaders and workers' representatives to the MOL and others.

15. The MOL continues to engage with international trade unions on a range of issues. Under the JWP, a dedicated project to support workers' activities is being finalized with the unions and is expected to begin in early 2025 (see paragraph 3).

16. Discussions are ongoing about the ILO Project Office in Doha becoming an ILO Country Office. The functions of the Country Office would build on the JWP with the MOL and seek to enhance partnerships with Qatar-based institutions to further advance the decent work agenda in the country, in the region, and globally.

▶ Pillar 1: Workforce policies

Labour market information system (LMIS)

17. The Ministry of Labour has prioritized the development of a labour market information system (LMIS), which will be a tool to anticipate labour market changes and inform policymaking. It will draw on a wide range of data sources to enable informed and impactful employment policies.

18. In May 2024, the MOL invited the ILO and other partners, including the United Nations Economic and Social Commission for Western Asia (ESCWA), to participate in a two-week workshop to discuss the development of the LMIS platform. The discussion covered the application of the various use cases of the LMIS, labour market indicators, strategies, and best practices for conducting surveys and structuring questionnaires. Progress updates on the LMIS are presented to the Workforce Planning Committee.

19. The ILO continues to work closely with the MOL's Information and Labour Market Research Department and the Transformation Management Office on two main inputs to the LMIS:

- The first Establishment Skills Survey (ESS) in Qatar, which will provide critical insights into Qatar's current and future workforce needs. The ESS is a comprehensive survey designed to collect data directly from employers across various sectors to identify existing skills gaps, shortages, and anticipate short-term future demands. This information is crucial for enhancing workforce capabilities and shaping effective labour market policies, supporting NDS3 goals related to economic diversification and the creation of a highly skilled workforce. In December 2024, the MOL and ILO organized a workshop titled "Shaping the Future Workforce: A Quick Dive into the Establishment Skills Survey (ESS)" facilitated by the International Training Center of the ILO (ITC-ILO) to begin work on the design of the survey instrument and methodology.
- The TCP is working with the Qatar Financial Centre (QFC) on a sectoral study on skills in Qatar's financial sector that complements the broader ESS. While the ESS covers a wide range of sectors, this study zeroes in on the financial industry, identifying current and short-term future skills requirements, particularly considering the ongoing digital transformation. This data-driven approach will enable targeted upskilling strategies and align education and training programs with industry demands.

20. Another key input to the LMIS is the labour force survey. Representatives from the MOL and the National Planning Council participated in an online training course on designing a labour force survey in May and June 2024 delivered by the ITC-ILO. Officials from the MOL also participated in an online course on LMIS by the ITC-ILO in June 2024. While the ESS provides insights into employers' skills demand, the labour force survey serves as a valuable tool for understanding the skills supply, among other key aspects. The LMIS acts as the framework through which these data points are effectively communicated to their intended audiences, whether it is the Government for policymaking or other entities for information and dissemination purposes.

21. The ILO has been sharing tools, approaches, and international good practices with the Higher Education Department of Qatar Foundation (QF) as they work on a tracer study of QF graduates. QF has already presented the approach to other higher education institutions in the country and found that there is interest in replicating it.

Skills and lifelong learning

22. In April 2024, UNESCO and the ILO partnered with UDST and the Ministry of Education and Higher Education (MOEHE) to organize the "International Symposium on Education and Skills for a Future-Ready Workforce: STEM and TVET for a Sustainable and Resilient Society." The objective of the symposium was to initiate a

dialogue among education institutions, industry stakeholders, and policymakers on forward-looking academic initiatives to activate a responsive government and education industry ecosystem, drawing on regional and international best practice. The symposium resulted in the Doha Declaration on Education and Skills for Future Jobs consisting concrete recommendations from the participants that can be used to inform the development of institutional, national, and regional plans.

23. The ILO is working with the MOL to further develop the Qatar National Occupation Classification (QNOC) system from occupation-based classifications (aligned with ISCO-08) to a more detailed, skills-based framework providing deeper insights into job requirements and skills gaps. With support from the European Commission, the TCP will work to align QNOC with the ESCO (European multilingual classification of Skills, Competences and Occupations) occupations pillar. The collaboration will follow a two-phase approach: an initial automated mapping in early 2025 followed by a more comprehensive one-to-one mapping by the second quarter of 2025.

24. The ILO designed and conducted a capacity building training on occupational classification systems in March 2024. The two-day online training provided the technical skills and knowledge needed to develop, use, and maintain a national occupation classification system to around 20 representatives from different departments of the MOL.

25. The ILO presented on the process and value of alignment of the QNOC with ISCO and international frameworks at the Doha Data Forum in October 2024.

Small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs)

26. In 2024, the TCP supported the mapping of pro-productivity organizations, networks, and programmes in Qatar as part of a regional ILO research initiative covering the Middle East and North Africa (MENA). This assessment will inform a workshop on SME productivity measurement and analysis for National Productivity Organizations in 2025.

27. In May 2024, the ILO participated in a roundtable discussion titled "Self-Employment Drivers and Its Socio-Economic Environment in Qatar and the Region," hosted by the Qatar Chamber of Commerce and Industry (QCCI) and co-organized with the Center for Entrepreneurship & Organizational Excellence (CEOE) at Qatar University's College of Business and Economics (QUCBE).

28. The ILO, MOL and the WSIF are partnering with Nama, an entity of Qatar Social Work under the Ministry of Social Development and Family (MSDF) to roll out the ILO Gender and Entrepreneurship Together (GET Ahead) training program. The training will target migrant women workers who are beneficiaries of the Fund's recreational programmes. The Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) between the entities is currently being finalized, with the training of lead trainers planned in 2025.

29. In November 2024, the ILO co-organized a panel discussion alongside the CEOE and the QCCI on the topic of "Responsible business practices: Sharing practical knowledge to promote a new generation of responsible business leaders within the Arab countries" at the ROWAD Entrepreneurship Conference and the Arab SMEs Summit (ASMES) that took place in Qatar.

Gender equality and non-discrimination

30. The Government of Qatar has ratified Convention No. 111 and is required to report periodically to the ILO Committee of Experts on the Application of Conventions and Recommendations (CEACR) on the measures it has taken for its implementation in law and practice. In October 2024, Qatar submitted its report to the CEACR, responding to the Committee's observations adopted in 2022. The work of the TCP aligns with this Convention, and also the targets on "Social Cohesion" set out in NDS3 and the MOL's National Strategy for 2024-2030, such

as to have 35 per cent of leadership positions occupied by women and a 30 per cent participation rate of persons with disabilities in the labour force."[5]

31. In July 2024, the Office of the United Nations High Commissioner for Human Rights (OHCHR)'s Regional Office for the Middle East and North Africa, the Arab Network for National Human Rights Institutions (ANNHRI), and Qatar's NHRC organized a two-day regional dialogue titled "Promoting Equality and Combating Discrimination, including in the Context of Migration," inviting representatives from different GCC National Human Rights Institutions (NHRIs). During the event, the ILO presented on the Discrimination (Employment and Occupation) Convention (No. 111) and facilitated a discussion between the NHRIs and QF's Worker Welfare Department. The discussion focused on the collaboration between QF, the MOL, and the ILO on ways public procurement processes can integrate protections against discrimination in employment for migrant workers, emphasizing the importance of workers' voice and gender-responsive grievance mechanisms.

32. In August 2024, the WSIF in partnership with the ILO, the Ministry of Public Health (MOPH), Qatar Red Crescent (QRC), and the Building and Wood Workers' International (BWI) launched a series of training sessions for companies focused on workplace mental health. The sessions have been delivered to companies in the hospitality and telecommunications sectors, with approximately 125 workers' and management representatives participating. The WSIF plans to expand the training to around 60 companies across the hospitality, telecommunications, and construction sectors on a rolling basis. The ILO's contribution to these trainings includes an introduction to the Violence and Harassment Convention (No.190). The session equips companies with the tools to conduct risk assessments in the workplace and implement strategies and policies to mitigate the identified risks of violence and harassment.

33. In August 2024, the MOL and the ILO organized a four-day workshop on International Labour Standards (ILS), the ILO's supervisory mechanism, and Member States' reporting obligations. The workshop was attended by staff from the MOL's International Cooperation Department and other technical departments. A significant portion of the discussions focused on improving reporting practices related to Convention No. 111. The workshop also emphasized the role of Member States in the global standard-setting process, with a particular focus on the upcoming discussions during the International Labour Conference (ILC) in 2025 and 2026 on decent work in the platform economy.

34. The TCP is actively supporting the MOL in implementing gender-sensitive programming. MOL officials participated in the ITC-ILO Gender Academy in Turin in November 2023. The TCP also supported the WSIF in organizing an event to mark the International Day of Women in Diplomacy on 1 July 2024. The event featured a panel of women engaged in labour diplomacy in Qatar including: (i) grassroots leaders from the Women Migrant Community Leaders' Forum; (ii) international civil servants who facilitate Government-to-Government knowledge exchanges with the WSIF; (iii) labour attachés from embassies who bridge the WSIF and their communities in Qatar; and (iv) representatives from UN agencies facilitating technical exchanges with the WSIF. The panel discussion culminated in the announcement of the launch of the Get Ahead Programme (see paragraph 28).

Labour mobility

35. It has been four years since the adoption of the legislation removing the legal requirement for workers to obtain permission from their employers, in the form of a No Objection Certificate (NOC), to change jobs. This has resulted in greater labour mobility with workers able to find new and better opportunities, and employers able to identify and recruit workers more easily within Qatar.

- Until the end of September 2024, 50,127 men and 10,124 women have had their applications to change jobs approved. As in previous years, the overall proportion of women who changed jobs in this period mirrors the overall proportion of women in the workforce (16.8 per cent).

[5] More information on the strategic outcomes of the NDS3 can be found here.

- In 2024, there were 3,399 approved applications to change jobs from domestic workers, with 60 per cent of the applications coming from men.
- The highest number of workers changing jobs continues to be in the construction sector (approximately one-third), which is reflective of the overall size of the sector in the labour market.

36. Throughout 2024, the ILO and MOL collaborated with Strategy Hub to assess the *kafala* reforms, with a focus on the labour mobility reforms. This study examined the impact of the reforms on the labour market, on workers, and on employers of different sizes in different sectors in Qatar. The study draws from different sources of information:

- MOL and Ministry of Interior (MOI) data from September 2018 to August 2023 including on employment change, labour permits, employment contracts, and QID cancellation. Employment change approvals for workers increased by around 830 per cent in a year since the reforms were adopted in September 2020 until August 2021, in comparison to the year before the reforms. The data analysed showed that there has been a gradual steady increase in number of female workers who have applied to change jobs.
- An enterprise survey, which was administered through multiple channels to ensure broad participation from companies across various sectors. The survey was disseminated by the MOL, various international business councils, and associations of human resources (HR) professionals. It assessed factors such as recruitment practices, job matching, cost implications, and investments in skills development of workers before and after the reforms were adopted in September 2020 to offer a comparative view. The survey findings highlighted that although respondents were aware of the labour reforms, a significant majority of employers asked for NOCs or equivalent documents when recruiting workers locally.
- The two main reasons provided for this requirement were to mitigate delays in the process of employment transfer, and to avoid potential conflicts with the former employer. The findings also reflected that while large enterprises still relied mainly on recruiting workers from abroad,[6] SMEs reported a 20 per cent decrease in their cross-border hiring between 2019-2023. The enterprise survey also looked at the retention rate amongst workers recruited locally versus workers recruited from abroad during the period.

37. The MOL launched a new revised version of the electronic employment change platform in May 2024. The new system enables both workers and new employers to initiate the employment change (EC) application. Upon the submission of the application by the new employer, the system notifies the worker for his/her approval. The system no longer requires the submission of the EC paper form which previously needed to be filled, signed, and uploaded into the previous system by the worker. This aims to enhance efficiency, reduce the burden on workers, and address challenges related to omissions or inaccurate information filled in the paper form. This is substantial as omissions or technical problems were among the main reasons for rejection of the EC application in the old system.

38. Under this system, the new employer needs to input the working and living conditions including the contract period, job title, probation period, basic monthly wage and other financial entitlements. The worker then is able to review the information and approve or reject the application. This avoids any changes made to the terms and conditions of the new job after the EC application has been approved. The platform is now functioning more efficiently than when the system was first introduced. In September, the average number of days to process an EC application was 9, compared to 6 in September 2023, but down from 22 days in August 2021.

39. The MOL has published user guides on the new system for employers and workers in Arabic and English. The MOL also presented the new platform to the community liaison officers (CLOs) of international trade unions

[6] With the lead up to the FIFA World Cup in 2022, an increase in the total workforce of the country could be observed.

as a part of its efforts to raise awareness. Under the TCP, the ILO plans to coordinate with the MOL to conduct further awareness raising activities in the coming months.

40. Since the adoption of Law No. 13 of 2018 and Ministerial Decision No. 95 of 2019 by the Ministry of Interior, migrant workers have had the right to leave the country either temporarily or permanently without prior approval from their employers. An exception was created for five per cent of a company's workforce, restricted to certain senior positions and for which approval would need to be granted. During 2024, there were 4,759 requests for exit permits. The majority of the requests came from the following sectors: construction, retail, transport, cleaning, and manufacturing. In comparison, there were 13,282 requests for exit permits between January and October 2023.

Attracting and retaining talent

41. The ILO and the MOL collaborated with Fragomen in Qatar to initiate a study to assess whether the immigration and work permit systems address the current and future needs of the labour market. In early 2024, companies of various sizes and across sectors were consulted in a roundtable including: (i) local Qatari enterprises; (ii) foreign business councils and their members; and (iii) semi-governmental entities and relevant government entities.

42. A comprehensive benchmarking and comparative analysis were conducted to understand the differences and similarities between immigration systems worldwide. This also included analyzing regional and global jurisdictions focusing on long-term residency schemes, nationalization policies, remote working schemes, intracompany transfers, and trusted employer schemes.

- In line with QNV 2030, the study puts forward a set of 26 main recommendations revolving around economic growth and retention of workers, addressing the unique challenges and opportunities within Qatar's labour and immigration frameworks. Some of the key recommendations include improving pre-departure immigration processes, ensuring effective and transparent employment change process, and introducing flexible visa quota requirements.
- One recommendation of the study is to establish a 'Trusted Employer Scheme' in Qatar through which eligible enterprises that have demonstrated compliance with national legislation, including labour and immigration laws, can be incentivized through streamlined immigration processes. Beneficiaries could see reduced visa processing times and facilitated recruitment and transfer of employees across borders. They would also be required to demonstrate adherence to laws, with periodic reviews to ensure that they maintain compliance. The scheme would also promote transparency by maintaining up-to-date records on workers' legal status, wages, and working conditions, with real-time reporting to build trust with regulatory bodies. The design of the Trusted Employer Scheme is currently underway with a view to initiating a pilot phase in 2025.

Fair recruitment

43. The ILO has been providing technical inputs to the MOL to review the legal framework on regulating private recruitment agencies in Qatar. In 2024, the ILO conducted a comprehensive review of the Ministerial Decision No. 8 of 2005 regarding the conditions and procedures for obtaining a license to recruit foreign workers for others, and Ministerial Decision No. 21 of 2021 amending certain provisions of Ministerial Decision No. 8 of 2005 in line with international labour standards and good practices. Some key recommendations include:

- Expanding the criteria to obtain a license to recruit workers to require that applicants have the necessary qualifications and are not involved in crimes related to fraud, violence, forced labour and trafficking in persons.
- Requiring the applicant to submit documents related to internal company policies and systems to ensure compliance with relevant national legislation.

- To address concerns of workers and employers, it has also been recommended to include a legal provision on mandatory inspection of the accommodation of private recruitment agencies.

44. The MOL continues to monitor private recruitment agencies. In 2024, the Ministry has revoked the license of 8 agencies, and has also published a list of registered recruitment agencies on their website. Under the TCP, the MOL and ILO are looking to develop concrete licensing standards and a standardized process of issuing and renewing licenses for private recruitment agencies in Qatar. In 2025, the MOL will initiate an overall assessment of the labour inspection framework (see paragraph 51), including the existing process of inspecting private recruitment agencies in Qatar.

45. In 2024, the MOL took up the role of co-chair at the ILO Fair Recruitment Initiative Advisory Committee. This Committee was established in 2022 to provide advice on strategic priorities and areas of action to the ILO's global strategy on fair recruitment. The State of Qatar has been a member of the committee since its inception.

Artificial intelligence (AI) and decent work

46. As is the case worldwide, there is great interest in Qatar on the impact of generative artificial intelligence (AI) on jobs. The ILO co-chaired a track on the subject at the Qatar University College of Business and Economics (QUCBE)'s Center for Entrepreneurship and Organizational Excellence (CEOE)'s seventh annual conference on Entrepreneurship for Sustainability & Impact (ESI) in November 2024, titled "Redefining Business in the Era of AI Revolution."

47. In October 2024, the ILO participated in a panel discussion at a Human Resource Symposium hosted by the University of Doha for Science and Technology (UDST) on "Synergy at Work: Unlocking Peak Productivity through Well-Being and Engagement in the Era of Generative AI."

48. The ILO presented at an event organized by Georgetown University in Qatar in December 2024 on the subject of "AI Uprising: Opportunities and Challenges for the Future of Work and Its Impact on the Environment."

49. Also in December, the MOL and the ILO co-organized a high-level panel on the future of work, including examining the impact of technology, at the annual Doha Forum.

▶ Pillar 2: Labour market governance

Labour inspection

50. Up until September 2024, the MOL's Labour Inspection Department inspected 23,438 companies, 12,094 worksites (i.e. construction sites), and 5,063 accommodation sites.

51. The MOL is initiating a comprehensive review of the labour inspection framework, with the view to establishing an 'intelligence-based system' that leverages technology and best practice. Procedures will be re-engineered to enhance compliance with the labour laws to protect workers' rights, providing a clear and consistent regulatory environment, and reducing administrative burdens. The inspection functions cover working conditions, occupational safety and health, accommodation, recruitment agencies, and compliance with the new nationalization law. The ILO has provided inputs on the scope of the review and will be working closely with the MOL throughout the process in 2025.

52. A series of trainings are planned in collaboration with the International Organization for Migration (IOM) on the subject of forced labour and trafficking in persons (FL/TIP) for MOL officials. The trainings aimed at providing the MOL and other officers, including inspectors, with the necessary technical knowledge to identify and investigate possible cases of FL/TIP and refer those to the mandated public prosecution bodies in Qatar.

Occupational safety and health (OSH)

53. The Ministry of Labour has initiated the establishment of a National OSH Committee that would have a number of responsibilities, including enhancing coordination on OSH matters among government and private sector entities. The Committee could look into reviewing OSH legislation, the accreditation of OSH professionals in the country, and also the possible ratification of ILO OSH conventions. One of the outstanding priorities remains the collection and analysis of data on occupational injuries and diseases.

54. The ILO is supporting the MOL in the comprehensive review of OSH legislation. This includes a gap analysis of the national legal framework against ILO conventions and recommendations. The report presents a number of recommendations for legal amendments. A second gap analysis was also conducted focusing on regulating the production and use of chemical agents in Qatar. There are plans for field research of the production and use of chemicals in collaboration with UDST starting in 2025.

55. The TCP has continued to support capacity building in the MOL's OSH Department. A training plan comprising different aspects of OSH operational capacities for inspectors was adopted and is under implementation. It includes specialized trainings on specific categories of hazards and risks (e.g., ergonomics, chemicals, construction and others), as well as accidents' investigations, data collection, analysis of occupational accidents, and the planning of operations.

56. In February 2024, a training was conducted on managing risks and risk assessments for OSH professionals from Ashghal as well as workers' and management representatives from joint committees in the retail, hospitality, manufacturing, and facilities maintenance sectors in Qatar. The training was supported by the TCP and the Embassy of the United Kingdom in Qatar and was delivered by a trainer certified by the UK-based National Examination Board in Occupational Safety and Health (NEBOSH). Over 50 participants received an internationally recognized certification on OSH after passing the post-training exam.

57. In the framework of the programme on a gender-responsive labour inspectorate developed with the Swedish Work Environment Authority (SWEA), a technical exchange visit to Sweden took place in December 2024. The exchange was on the subject of ergonomic hazards and risks with a special focus on sectors in which women

are more likely to be working in Qatar. The mission included technical workshops, inspection visits, and the development of a checklist on inspection of ergonomic hazards and risks for field inspectors.

58. The ILO, in collaboration with the MOL and MOI, developed awareness raising materials on "Road Safety," a major cause of occupational injuries in Qatar. A number of consultations were held with delivery riders, the International Transport Workers' Federation (ITF), and relevant stakeholders (delivery and other companies in the transport sector, academia, the traffic police, embassies and others) in order to develop and to promote the materials.

- An animation video was produced in multiple languages in May 2024, portraying the main causes of road accidents and good practices in promoting road safety for workers. The animation has been disseminated through different channels including through community leaders, embassies, and the Qatar Red Crescent for viewing at their network of clinics.
- Another awareness raising event on road safety was organized in November 2024 in collaboration with the Ghanaian Embassy in Qatar and the WSIF targeting workers in the delivery sector. It involved over 300 riders and drivers, and was facilitated by the food delivery companies, MOL, MOI, migrant community leaders, and the ILO.

59. The MOL conducted a campaign to protect workers from heat stress. The campaign involved targeted inspection visits, focusing on construction worksites, the agricultural sector, delivery companies, and others. This led to 368 worksites being shut down for non-compliance with the legislation. In the same context of the annual heat stress campaign, the ILO participated in numerous awareness raising activities in collaboration with BWI and other partners targeting workers and management of companies in the manufacturing, construction, and security sectors.

60. Following the international conference on occupational heat stress organized by the Government of Qatar and the ILO in 2023, the ILO launched a "Heat and OSH Policy Brief: Best practices in the GCC region and beyond" in June 2024. The brief presents a summary of discussions and outcomes from the international conference regarding policy actions to tackle workplace heat stress.

Wages

61. The Wage Protection System (WPS) enables the Government of Qatar to monitor salaries and allowances paid to workers, and to detect violations. The system can reduce wage disputes and alleviate some of the workload of the Dispute Resolution Department and the Labour Dispute Settlement Committees. In September 2024, 102,786 companies sent their salary information files to the WPS.

62. A block is automatically imposed on a company when the system detects that a worker has not been paid or has been paid less than the minimum wage (the system cannot yet detect whether the wage paid according to the salary information file is less than specified by the employment contract). Sometimes these events are administrative reporting errors on the part of the company. In such instances, the MOL will communicate with the company to obtain additional information. If the violation is confirmed and not immediately rectified, a violation notice is issued. A legislative amendment is currently being considered to automatically issue fines in case of non-payment of wages.

▶ **Table 1: Enforcement of the WPS by the MOL (2019 – 30 September 2024)**

Period	Number of companies blocked by WPS	Number of violation notices issued
2019	48,328	2,318
2020	25,200	3,360
2021	27,441	3,102
2022	28,266	7,769
2023	19,445	4,595
2024 (up to 30 September)	18,802	5,667

63. The TCP has provided inputs to a report by the ILO Regional Office for the Arab States (ROAS) entitled "Wage Protection Systems in the Gulf Council Cooperation Countries: a regional analysis." The ILO has submitted a set of recommendations on both immediate and mid-term interventions to enhance the efficiency of the WPS.

64. The MOL's Law No. 17 of 2020 on Setting the Minimum Wage for Workers and Domestic Workers established the Minimum Wage Commission. The commission reviews the minimum wage amount on a periodic basis. The TCP is promoting the collection and analysis of wage-related data, and also the participation of workers in the consultations on the minimum wage.

Responsible business conduct (RBC)

65. To promote compliance with national labour laws and regulations, the TCP has strengthened its engagement with business schools and other stakeholders in Qatar. Additionally, the TCP has increased its participation in local and international conferences focused on responsible business conduct, climate change, corporate social responsibility, and Environmental, Social, and Governance (ESG) issues.

Engagement with businesses

66. The TCP has engaged with various networks of human resources (HR) professionals in Qatar including the Qatar HR Forum (QHRF) which brings together over 400 HR professionals from sectors such as banking, retail, and education; the Philippine Human Resource Practitioners - Qatar (PHRPQ), a network of more than 370 Filipino HR professionals working across different industries in Qatar; and the Schools' HR Practitioners' Network in Qatar, comprising 60 HR professionals from private schools.

- In January 2024, the TCP delivered a workshop to over 80 members of the different Qatar HR communities on grievance management in line with the labour law.
- In June 2024, the TCP co-hosted a discussion with the QHRF on "The Role of HR in Shaping Organizational Culture," emphasizing the importance of social dialogue and joint committees in creating safe and inclusive workplaces.

Engagement with business schools

67. In 2023, the TCP partnered with Qatar University's College of Business and Economics (QUCBE) to develop a Casebook on Business and Human Rights. The casebook includes context-specific case studies documenting challenges and opportunities for responsible business conduct in both the private and public sectors in Qatar. Eight case studies have been finalized and are currently under review, with publication and an executive training launch planned in collaboration with the Center for Entrepreneurship and Excellence (CEOE) at QUCBE for April-May 2025.

68. In the context of the development of the Casebook, the TCP facilitated exchanges between the Global Business School Network (GBSN), the NYU Stern Center for Business and Human Rights, the Geneva School of Economics and Management at the University of Geneva, and the QUCBE in 2023. This has led to the QUCBE joining the GBSN and participating in the GBSN for Business and Human Rights Impact Community 7th Annual Meeting in November 2023. This collaboration will continue with further discussions on how to mainstream human rights into business education in the region.

69. In October 2023, the QUCBE launched the MENA Business Schools Alliance for Sustainability (MEBAS), a network of 14 business schools across eight countries in the Middle East and North Africa (MENA) region. The ILO is a supporting partner for this initiative.[7] The network includes institutions such as the University of Dubai, Ajman University, Ecole de Management (Morocco), Prince Sultan University, UAE University, Princess Sumaya University for Technology, Kuwait University, the University of Cyprus, and more. In the United Nations Responsible Business and Human Rights Forum, an Asia regional meeting which took place in Bangkok in September 2024, the MEBAS example of adapting and developing locally relevant teaching material for business and human rights was discussed as a best practice.

70. On the margins of the QCSR Summit in April 2024 (see paragraph 73), the ILO in collaboration with MEBAS organized a workshop on decent work and sustainable chain management for business, logistics, and supply chain professors from the MEBAS network institutions. Following this course, the TCP co-created teaching materials on "Decent Work in Sustainable Supply Chains" with the ILO Helpdesk for Business and the attending MEBAS professors. In July 2024, the TCP organized a webinar to discuss and validate the draft teaching materials and exchange ideas on region-specific case studies and activities for inclusion in later versions.

71. In 2025, the TCP is planning a workshop in Qatar to expand the use of these materials locally, bringing together academics from various disciplines including business education, supply chain logistics, corporate law, and others to discuss how to integrate these concepts into local classrooms. Simultaneously, the TCP will be organizing a workshop using the teaching materials as a basis for joint committee management representatives in a number of sectors including facilities management, manufacturing, retail, etc. in collaboration with QF's Worker Welfare Department.

72. In February 2024, the TCP was invited to join the Human Resource Management (HRM) Program Advisory Committee Meeting of the UDST to provide suggestions for its Bachelor of Business Administration in HRM and Master of Science in HRM programs, considering new labour market and industry trends.

Participation in conferences to raise the profile of labour rights in RBC

73. At the 2024 Qatar Corporate Social Responsibility (QCSR) Summit, the theme was "The Future of CSR in a Circular Economy." The ILO, in collaboration with the MOL, the QUCBE, and MEBAS, organized three panels featuring 18 international and national experts on the circular economy. The discussions addressed key topics such as government policies for transitioning to a circular economy, companies adopting circular business models, converting waste into value, the potential for industrial symbiosis in Qatar, and leveraging academic expertise to advance circularity. Outcomes from the panels include:

- A report drafted by the TCP and Hamad Bin Khalifa University (HBKU)'s College of Public Policy on the circular economy in Qatar. This will serve as a foundation for multi-stakeholder discussions at HBKU on topics including circularity, occupational health and safety, skills, and social dialogue in 2025.
- A Masterclass on the circular economy in the region, in the process of finalisation by the ITC-ILO. It documents the key interventions made by the panellists over the three days of the QCSR Summit. The masterclass consists of 13 videos with international and Qatar-based experts on the circular economy and responsible business conduct (RBC) and will be publicly accessible on the ITC-ILO website once live.

[7] For more information, please see this article.

74. On 2 April at the QCSR Summit, the TCP further collaborated with the embassies of the Netherlands, Sweden, Switzerland, and the EU Delegation in Doha to organize a panel on responsible business conduct. The event focused on discussing the implications of the European Union Corporate Sustainability Reporting Directive and the Corporate Sustainability Due Diligence Directive for businesses operating in Qatar. The event also brought together representatives from local business development service providers and academia to explore building an ecosystem that promotes RBC in Qatar, supporting companies in aligning their practices with Qatar's Labour Law and these new international guidelines.

75. This discussion continued in September 2024 in the form of a roundtable with representatives ranging from local human resources practitioners, international business councils, embassies, business school professors, NGOs, and the MOL. The event was organized in collaboration with the Embassy of the Kingdom of the Netherlands in Qatar and the Gulf Sustain Initiative of the Institute for Human Rights and Business (IHRB) and focused on existing knowledge and skills gaps in meeting the new requirements in Qatar. This initiative will be the first of a series of engagements with the listed stakeholders to expand the inclusion of labour and human rights into local business practices, starting in 2025.

76. The ILO participated in the inaugural Dialogue on Business and Human Rights in the Arab States Region co-organized by the NHRC, the ANNHRI, Global Alliance of National Human Rights Institutions (GANHRI), the UN Working Group on Business and Human Rights, OHCHR, and the UNDP in October 2024. The TCP also moderated the closing plenary panel of the event entitled "The Way Forward."

77. The ILO delivered opening remarks and participated at the ESG Qatar Conference in October 2024, focusing on strengthening social reporting among businesses, particularly on labour rights, through ESG reporting.

Community engagement

78. One of the highlights of 2024 has been the enhanced community engagement by the MOL and the WSIF. There has been extensive engagement with BWI, NHRC, embassies and different community groups throughout the year.

79. As part of the MOU signed by the MOL and Migrant Forum Asia (MFA) in October 2022, a series of trainings have been carried out for migrant community leaders. Four training sessions were held in 2024, with presentations from the MOL, WSIF, MOI, the Ministry of Public Health (MOPH), and others. The training sessions have covered all aspects of the labour law in Qatar, issues of workers' mental health as well as other relevant national policies and legislation (such as on migration, social services, and police operations).

80. In January 2024, an online workshop was organized by the ILO, MOL and the Embassy of Mexico on the Labour Rights of Foreign Workers in Qatar, to inform the Mexican resident community and the wider Spanish-speaking community in Qatar about their rights, obligations, and available resources according to the local labour law.

81. To mark International Labour Day in May 2024, the TCP collaborated with the WSIF and the 3-2-1 Qatar Olympic and Sports Museum to organize an event for workers to enjoy the exhibitions at the museum.

Dispute resolution

82. The MOL will shortly commence a review of the national legislation, policies, and mechanisms on dispute resolution with a view to introducing more effective processes and procedures. The ILO has worked closely with MOL on the scope of the review and in identifying challenges that migrant workers face in getting access to justice. Some recommendations are relatively easy to implement, while others require extensive capacity building or a legislative amendment.

83. The TCP, the CLOs of the international trade unions, and community leaders have continued to receive queries from workers, which are then referred to the MOL for action. This provides insight into the issues faced by migrant workers, and where implementation challenges remain. Through 2024, most of the queries received by the TCP involved unpaid wages and end-of-service benefits, as well as challenges in the process of changing

employers. Although employer retaliation remains an issue, the number of such cases received by the ILO has declined substantially compared to previous years.

84. In 2024, there has continued to be a decline in activity in the construction sector, as major infrastructure and building projects were completed ahead of the World Cup in 2022. While many of these workers have returned home, many other still have ongoing claims for due wages and end-of-service benefits. Unpaid wages and benefits continue to be the primary cause for complaints lodged at the MOL. Some workers manage to change employment, and therefore have an income while they are waiting for their cases to be resolved. Others may not find work, and therefore struggle, or in some cases leave Qatar without their due wages and benefits.

85. The number of complaints received by the MOL in 2024 – primarily through the online complaints and whistleblower portal – can be found below. Between January and September 2024, the online platform received 22,158 complaints. A quarter of these are referred to the Dispute Settlement Committees, which leads to a long period for workers to wait to have their cases heard.

▶ **Table 2: Labour complaints and outcomes (2022 – September 2024)**

Period	2022	2023	Up to 30 September 2024
Number of complaints	31,549	28,808	22,158
Proportion of complaints settled during conciliation	80%	75.2%	72.8%
Proportion of complaints sent to DSCs	19.5%	24.8%	25%
Proportion of complaints under review	0.5%	<1%	2.2%

Domestic work

86. The TCP continues to engage with various communities of domestic workers. In July 2024, the Assistant Undersecretary for Migrant Labour Affairs at the MOL met with domestic workers' community leaders representing the Ghanaian, Kenyan, and Filipino domestic workers in Qatar. Discussions were held around access to health cards, the wage protection system, referral mechanisms, and regulation of cleaning companies placing workers in private households. As a follow-up, an outreach and training plan will be developed for further engagement and support to domestic workers in Qatar.

87. The TCP continued to disseminate the Know Your Rights booklet for domestic workers in Qatar in 12 languages,[8] and the Guide to Employing a Migrant Domestic Worker in Qatar booklet for employers in two languages,[9] developed in partnership with Migrant-Rights.org.

88. A booklet for private recruitment agencies has been developed and published by MOL and ILO in partnership with The Fair Hiring Initiative. The booklet aims to raise awareness about the relevant legislation on domestic work and to equip private recruitment agencies with concrete steps they can take to facilitate an employment relationship that is mutually beneficial for domestic workers and their employers.

89. The MOL is planning to initiate an assessment and amendment to the Ministry's labour dispute management system (see paragraph 82). The scope of work will also include evaluating the current labour compliant

[8] Arabic, Bahasa, Bengali, English, Hindi, Malayalam, Nepali, Sinhala, Swahili, Tagalog, Telegu, and Urdu.

[9] Arabic and English.

systems and processes available for domestic workers. The TCP will provide technical inputs and complementary support.

▶ **Table 3: Complaints by or involving domestic workers (2021 – September 2024)**

Period	2021	2022	2023	Up to 30 Sept. 2024
Number of complaints	622	1530	577	317
Proportion of complaints settled before reaching Dispute Settlement Committees (DSCs)	83%	89%	92%	86%
Proportion of complaints sent to DSCs	16%	9%	8%	10%
Proportion of complaints under review	1%	1%	0	4%

90. The ILO collaborated with the IOM to draft and launch a "Code of Conduct for UN Employers of Domestic Workers in Qatar" in October 2024. The code is a voluntary commitment by UN staff in Qatar that demonstrates a shared responsibility to promote and protect the rights of domestic workers in both their professional and personal lives. The launch event was attended by UN staff in Qatar and domestic workers' community leaders along with MOL, Ministry of Foreign Affairs (MOFA), and representatives of diplomatic missions in Qatar. Information sessions aimed at supporting UN staff to implement the code have been rolled out starting November 2024.

Social protection

91. The ILO continues to engage with the MOL on policy discussions around a comprehensive social insurance scheme in Qatar. In line with international social security standards, possible key components of a benefit package, including but not limited to, employment injury and death compensation, unemployment benefits, sick leave and maternity and paternity leave; have been discussed.

92. Initial discussions on institutional arrangements for planning and implementing insurance schemes were also held. In August and September 2024, social protection specialists from the ILO Regional Office for the Arab States met with various relevant government and non-government entities to discuss the existing systems and schemes, and the needs of the labour market. In the coming year, the TCP will work on designing a potential social insurance package for workers in Qatar.

Social dialogue

93. Discussions are ongoing about legislative amendments that would make joint committees mandatory for companies in Qatar. Proposed revisions to Ministerial Decision No. 21 of 2019 include adjusting the threshold for establishing a committee, the term of joint committee members, the number of worker representatives, and the introduction of non-retaliation clauses and sanctions for non-compliant companies.

94. Lessons learned from the 73 joint committee pilots conducted by the MOL and ILO from 2019 to 2023 have informed key considerations for the MOL in the future rollout of mandatory joint committees. The short-term objectives include raising awareness of the forthcoming mandatory rollout of joint committees, exploring

sector-specific representation models, and identifying collective concerns. In the long term, the goal is to establish a national platform for social dialogue, build engagement with the Qatar Chamber of Commerce and Industry, and foster information-sharing and consultation on upcoming labour laws, regulations, and guidelines.

95. In preparation for the mandatory rollout of joint committees, information sessions were held in November 2023 for representatives from the education and banking sectors. These sessions presented electoral models suitable for schools and gathered information about existing grievance mechanisms commonplace in these sectors.

96. While all new joint committee elections are on hold pending the decisions on legislative amendments that would make joint committees mandatory, the TCP has supported the re-election of joint committees in several companies.

97. Recommendations also include improvements to the MOL's e-service platform to facilitate the registration and referral of collective disputes. The formation of an interdepartmental oversight team comprising of Inspection, Labour Relations, and Dispute Resolution departments has been suggested. A national rollout of a training program delivered through six modules via learning and development institutions is also proposed, with indicators recommended to monitor the effectiveness of joint committees.

Sectoral engagements

98. Discussions between the MOL and ILO are underway to establish either sectoral working groups consisting of management representatives, or Central Labour-Management Consultation Committees (CLMCCs), which would include both management and elected worker representatives. The decision on whether to form a working group or a CLMCC will depend on the prevalence of joint committees in the given sector. The CLMCC is preferred in sectors where a critical mass of joint committees has already been established, for example in transport, retail, and hospitality.

99. Meanwhile, sectoral engagement to promote joint committees is ongoing, with recent efforts focused on the education and banking sectors. Since 2022, the ILO has been working with the retail sector to promote enterprise-level social dialogue. In November 2023, the ILO and MOL organized a training session for participants from nine major retail companies on grievance handling. The training covered practical case studies, role-playing exercises, and introduced the Examination of Grievances Recommendation (No.130).

100. For the fifth consecutive year, the TCP supported the meetings of QF's CLMCC, also known as Tashawor, a platform bringing together workers' and management representatives from QF's supplier community. Meetings have been held in February, March, and July.

101. Following the rollout of the joint committee Module 4 training on Convention No. 111, elected workers' representatives from Qatar Foundation suppliers expressed interest in ensuring fair and transparent distribution of overtime hours among male and female workers, as well as workers of different nationalities and ethnicities. In response, QF's Tashawor formed an overtime subcommittee comprised of five workers' and seven management representatives in October 2023 to address the issue in detail.

102. The overtime subcommittee held its first meeting in December 2023, where the ILO provided guidance on equitable overtime distribution and comprehensive working hour monitoring systems. Sample company policy clauses on OT distribution were shared, and the role of workers' representatives in enforcing these policies was emphasized. The outcome of the meeting was an action plan set by the subcommittee to survey the wider QF supplier network, especially those management representatives responsible for overtime and payroll at the company, to gauge the successes and challenges in working hour management and overtime distribution.

103. Based on this, a survey was conducted in March 2024 targeting human resources, payroll, operations, and other management staff working in QF supplier companies. Input from workers' representatives was gathered via focus group discussions in a Tashawor meeting in March 2024. In total, ten companies responded to the

survey and the combined findings of the management survey and workers' focus group discussions were shared with the wider Tashawor meeting in July 2024.

Capacity-building programmes

104. Following a capacity building training on gender-specific workplace issues including discrimination, violence, and harassment, the ILO and MOL facilitated consultations with the women's subcommittee to develop a grievance escalation procedure that women suppliers can use when confronted with discrimination, violence or harassment by other suppliers, visitors, students, staff or faculty on campus.

105. In collaboration with Qatar Foundation, the TCP delivered a Training of Trainers (TOT) program to management and workers' representatives from across Qatar's joint committee community between September and October 2024. The objective of the TOT is to enhance the efficiency of organizing and delivering trainings by considering the changes to the structure and membership of JCs throughout Qatar. It also aimed to test the TOT methodology, identify potential lead trainers who could assist learning and development service providers in implementing the training program at the national level once joint committees become mandatory, and build the capacity of lead trainers to review evaluation methodologies for the TOT and JCs in collaboration with the MOL and other partners.

106. The TOT in September and October 2024 covered Modules One (on the roles and responsibilities of joint committee members) and Two (on employee participation rights) and was divided into three parts:

- An introduction to the content, including basic training and public speaking skills;
- a practice session where participants role-played delivering the training; and
- the actual delivery of the training to other JC representatives.

The Module 1 TOT had 24 participants, of which 15 were certified as lead trainers. The Module 2 TOT had a total of 23 participants with 20 certified as lead trainers.

107. In the context of an MOU between the Government of Qatar, the Netherlands, and the ILO on exchanges regarding social dialogue and collective dispute resolution, the ILO facilitated an exchange between the MOL and Dutch institutions. Ten officials from the MOL participated in the study tour in February 2024, meeting with Dutch ministries, the Social and Economic Council, the Netherlands Trade Union Confederation (FNV), and the Netherlands Enterprise Agency (RVO).

108. Based on the exchange, the ILO has facilitated two additional engagements between Dutch institutions and the MOL in Qatar. In October, the TCP worked with the MOL and SBI Formaat to organize consultations on the development of a joint committee training for occupational safety and health. The consultations included over 40 participants, ranging from joint committee management and workers' representatives from the retail, hospitality, transport, private security, manufacturing, and facilities maintenance sectors to OSH specialists and vocational trainers. The exchange also included site visits of MOL officials and the SBI Formaat to the workplaces of three companies with joint committees in different sectors.

109. Also in October, the TCP exchanged with the Ministry of Social Affairs and Employment in the Netherlands to discuss developing confidentiality and non-retaliation standard operating procedures for joint committees. The exchange included workshops with MOL officials in Qatar on employee participation rights, confidentiality policies, and non-retaliation in the joint committee context. The exchange concluded with the pilot of the Module 2 (on employee participation rights) training delivered by joint committee workers' and management representatives as per the TOT programme (see paragraph 106).

▶ Pillar 3: International cooperation and exchange of experience

Bilateral exchanges with other States

110. In recent years, a number of MOUs have been signed between Qatar, the ILO and other countries (France, Netherlands, and Sweden) – to facilitate the sharing of expertise and experience on a range of labour-related matters. In 2024, these exchanges continued, and specific activities are highlighted throughout the progress report.

111. In addition, there have been exchanges with other countries, including Singapore. In 2023, Singapore received a delegation from the WSIF, and in April 2024 a high-level delegation visited Qatar to exchange with the MOL and ILO on measures that Qatar has adopted to mitigate occupational heat stress.

Cooperation at the regional and global level

112. This year has seen a further deepening of cooperation at the GCC level. The ILO Regional Office has collaborated closely with the GCC Executive Bureau on a number of initiatives which the TCP has also contributed to. This includes support to an online regional meeting on the standard-setting process on decent work in the platform economy in July, and the Symposium on Education and Skills for a Future-Ready Workforce in April in Doha (see paragraph 49). Moreover, the TCP provided inputs on regional studies on wage protection systems, on social protection, and on absconding.

113. In May 2024, the MOL and the African Union Commission launched the Doha Dialogue – an inter-regional consultative process on labour mobility between the GCC, Jordan, Lebanon and the African Union member states. The ILO Regional Director for the Arab States presented an overview on effective labour migration governance and highlighted three key areas related to fair recruitment, skills development and recognition, and extension of social protection to migrant workers.

114. The MOL and ILO have participated in a number of meetings to share Qatar's experiences with other countries. For example, the TCP presented Qatar's experiences in promoting fair recruitment during the ITC training course on "Establishing Fair Recruitment Processes" in October 2024.

Advancing the decent work agenda in the region and globally

115. In 2024, the relationship between the ILO and various Qatari institutions has deepened significantly, reinforcing Qatar's commitment to advancing the decent work agenda nationally, regionally, and globally. This strengthening of ties is grounded in Qatar's broader commitment to multilateral cooperation, as explicitly mentioned in NDS3. During his address at the UN Summit of the Future in New York in September 2024, Qatar's Prime Minister emphasized Qatar's dedication to multilateralism and its role in supporting global development through the UN system.

116. Further at the Summit, the ILO invited QFFD to participate in the Youth Action Day multi-stakeholder panel titled "YouthLead: Innovative Solutions in Humanitarian Response - Youth-led Action in Forced Displacement and Humanitarian Emergencies," which spotlighted youth-driven responses to crises. Meanwhile, Silatech was invited to join a roundtable co-hosted by Microsoft Philanthropies on "AI Skills and Capacity Building in Hard-to-Reach Communities," focusing on leveraging artificial intelligence to empower marginalized communities.

117. In the scope of youth engagement, the ILO contributed to a conference in Doha organized by the Education Above All (EAA) Foundation on "Youth Empowerment in Climate Conflict" in April 2024. Following this, the ILO participated in a side event entitled "Education to Combat the Climate Crisis" in July 2024 during the High-Level Political Forum (HLPF) under the auspices of the UN Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC).

118. In June 2024, the Ministry of Foreign Affairs (MOFA) organized a landmark event bringing together UN agencies and over 60 national ministries and entities. This gathering aimed to enhance mutual understanding of the national and international mandates of UN agencies operating in Qatar and to foster greater cooperation across sectors.

119. Following the ILO's successful organization of two side events with the UN at the Doha Forum 2023, the ILO also supported two high-level events during the Forum in December 2024. The first was on the future of work co-organized with the MOL; and the other, co-organized by the ILO and QFFD, focused on "Women and Girls in Conflict and Post-Conflict Situations." This followed a joint webinar held in July 2024 between the ILO and QFFD on the ILO's work at the intersection of the humanitarian, development, and peacebuilding nexus.

120. The JWP signed between the ILO and the MOL includes a component on secondments. Currently, two MOL officials are temporarily assigned to departments in the ILO in Geneva. MOFA also has a Junior Professional Officer (JPO) programme. In June 2024, the ILO participated in a briefing alongside other UN agencies to introduce potential JPOs to the ILO's mandate and operations.

121. In February 2024, the MOL and the ILO co-hosted a high-level event to mark the World Day for Social Justice, the first such celebration in Doha.

122. In 2025, Qatar will host the second World Summit for Social Development (WSSD), a milestone event for the ILO and the global development community.

Contact details

International Labour Organization Project Office for the State of Qatar
3rd Floor, United Nations House
Zone No. 69; St. No. 100; Bldg. No. 334
P.O Box 18685
Lusail, Qatar

T: +974 4141 5205
E: doha@ilo.org

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